

Attacking DNS

The [Domain Name System \(DNS\)](#) translates domain names (e.g., [hackthebox.com](#)) to the numerical IP address. DNS is mostly [UDP/53](#), but DNS will rely on [TCP/53](#) more heavily as time progresses. DNS has always been designed to use port 53 from the start, with UDP being the default, and falls back to using TCP when it cannot communicate because the packet size is too large to push through in a single UDP packet. Since nearly all network applications use DNS, DNS servers represent one of the most prevalent and significant threats today.

Enumeration

DNS holds interesting information for an organization. As discussed in the [Domain Information](#) section in [Introduction to DNS](#), we can understand how a company operates and the services they provide, as well as third-party service providers.

The Nmap [-sC](#) (default scripts) and [-sV](#) (version scan) options can be used to perform initial enumeration.

Attacking DNS

```
dbcyph0n@htb[/htb]# nmap -p53 -Pn -sV -sC 10.10.110.213
```

```
Starting Nmap 7.80 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2020-10-29 03:47 EDT
```

```
Nmap scan report for 10.10.110.213
```

```
Host is up (0.017s latency).
```

PORT	STATE	SERVICE	VERSION
53/tcp	open	domain	ISC BIND 9.11.3-1ubuntu1.2 (Ubuntu Linux)

DNS Zone Transfer

A DNS zone is a portion of the DNS namespace that a specific organization or administrator manages. Since DNS zones are hierarchical, DNS servers utilize DNS zone transfers to copy a portion of their database to another DNS server. If configured correctly (limiting which IPs can perform a DNS zone transfer), anyone can ask a DNS server for a zone transfer since DNS zone transfers do not require any authentication. In addition, the DNS service usually runs on a

```
inlanefrieght.htb.          604800  IN      SOA      localhost. root.localhost. 2 604800
;; Query time: 28 msec
;; SERVER: 10.129.110.213#53(10.129.110.213)
;; WHEN: Mon Oct 11 17:20:13 EDT 2020
;; XFR size: 8 records (messages 1, bytes 289)
```

Tools like [Fierce](#) can also be used to enumerate all DNS servers of the root domain and scan for a DNS zone transfer.

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```
dbcyp0n@htb[/htb]# fierce --domain zonetransfer.me
```

```
NS: nsztl2.digi.ninja. nsztl1.digi.ninja.
```

```
SOA: nsztl1.digi.ninja. (81.4.108.41)
```

```
Zone: success
```

```
<DNS name @>: '@ 7200 IN SOA nsztl1.digi.ninja. robin.digi.ninja. 2019100801 '
               '172800 900 1209600 3600\n'
               '@ 300 IN HINFO "Casio fx-700G" "Windows XP"\n'
               '@ 301 IN TXT '
               '"google-site-verification=tyP28J7JAUHA9fw2sHXMgcCC0I6XBmmoVi04VLMewxA"'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 0 ASPMX.L.GOOGLE.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 10 ALT1.ASPMX.L.GOOGLE.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 10 ALT2.ASPMX.L.GOOGLE.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 20 ASPMX2.GOOGLEMAIL.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 20 ASPMX3.GOOGLEMAIL.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 20 ASPMX4.GOOGLEMAIL.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN MX 20 ASPMX5.GOOGLEMAIL.COM.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN A 5.196.105.14\n'
               '@ 7200 IN NS nsztl1.digi.ninja.\n'
               '@ 7200 IN NS nsztl2.digi.ninja.',
```

```
<DNS name _acme-challenge>: '_acme-challenge 301 IN TXT '
                           '"60a05hbUJ9xSsvYy7pApQvwCUSSGgxrbdizjePEsZI"',
```

```
<DNS name _sip._tcp>: '_sip._tcp 14000 IN SRV 0 0 5060 www',
```

```
<DNS name 14.105.196.5.IN-ADDR.ARPA>: '14.105.196.5.IN-ADDR.ARPA 7200 IN PTR '
                                       'www',
```

```
<DNS name asfdbauthdns>: 'asfdbauthdns 7900 IN AFSD 1 asfdbbox',
```

```
<DNS name asfdbbox>: 'asfdbbox 7200 IN A 127.0.0.1',
```

```
<DNS name asfdbvolume>: 'asfdbvolume 7800 IN AFSD 1 asfdbbox',
```

```
<DNS name canberra-office>: 'canberra-office 7200 IN A 202.14.81.230',
```

```
<DNS name cmdexec>: 'cmdexec 300 IN TXT "; ls"',
```

```
<DNS name contact>: 'contact 2592000 IN TXT "Remember to call or email Pippa '
                    'on +44 123 4567890 or pippa@zonetransfer.me when making '
                    'DNS changes"',
```

```
<DNS name dc-office>: 'dc-office 7200 IN A 143.228.181.132',
```

```
<DNS name deadbeef>: 'deadbeef 7201 IN AAAA dead:beef::',
```

```
<DNS name dr>: 'dr 300 IN LOC 53 20 56.558 N 1 38 33.526 W 0.00m',
```

```
<DNS name DZC>: 'DZC 7200 IN TXT "AbCdEfG"',
```

```
<DNS name email>: 'email 2222 IN NAPTR 1 1 "P" "E2U+email" "" '

```

the claimed domain.

Domain takeover is also possible with subdomains called **subdomain takeover**. A DNS's canonical name different domains to a parent domain. Many organizations use third-party services like AWS, GitHub, Akamai delivery networks (CDNs) to host their content. In this case, they usually create a subdomain and make it point to the example,

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```
sub.target.com.    60    IN    CNAME    anotherdomain.com
```

The domain name (e.g., **sub.target.com**) uses a CNAME record to another domain (e.g., **anotherdomain.com**). If **anotherdomain.com** expires and is available for anyone to claim the domain since the **target.com**'s DNS record is still pointing to **anotherdomain.com**, in that case, anyone who registers **anotherdomain.com** will have complete control over **sub.target.com** until the record is updated.

Subdomain Enumeration

Before performing a subdomain takeover, we should enumerate subdomains for a target domain using tools like **subfinder** to scrape subdomains from open sources like **DNSdumpster**. Other tools like **Sublist3r** can also be used to enumerate subdomains by supplying a pre-generated wordlist:

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```
dbcyph0n@htb[/htb]# ./subfinder -d inlanefreight.com -v
```

```
____ _| |__ / _()_ _ _| |__ _ _
(_< || | ' \ _| | ' \ / _ / -_) ' |
/_/_/\_,|_.../_| | | | \_, \ _ _| | v2.4.5
      projectdiscovery.io
```

```
[WRN] Use with caution. You are responsible for your actions
```

```
[WRN] Developers assume no liability and are not responsible for any misuse or damage.
```

```
[WRN] By using subfinder, you also agree to the terms of the APIs used.
```

```
[INF] Enumerating subdomains for inlanefreight.com
```

```
[alienvault] www.inlanefreight.com
```

```
[dnsdumpster] ns1.inlanefreight.com
```

```
[dnsdumpster] ns2.inlanefreight.com
```

```
...snip...
```

```
[bufferover] Source took 2.193235338s for enumeration
```

```
ns2.inlanefreight.com
www.inlanefreight.com
ms1.inlanefreight.com
support.inlanefreight.com
```

<SNIP>

Sometimes internal physical configurations are poorly secured, which we can exploit to upload our tools for. One scenario would be that we have reached an internal host through pivoting and want to work from there. Other alternatives, but it does not hurt to know alternative ways and possibilities.

The tool has found four subdomains associated with [inlanefreight.com](#). Using the `nslookup` or `host` command to check CNAME records for those subdomains.

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```
dbcyp0n@htb[/htb]# host support.inlanefreight.com

support.inlanefreight.com is an alias for inlanefreight.s3.amazonaws.com
```

The `support` subdomain has an alias record pointing to an AWS S3 bucket. However, the URL <https://support.inlanefreight.s3.amazonaws.com> shows a `NoSuchBucket` error indicating that the subdomain is potentially vulnerable to a subdomain takeover. This is because the subdomain is pointing to an AWS S3 bucket with the same subdomain name.

This XML file does not appear to have any style information associated with it. The document root is:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8" ?>
<Error>
  <Code>NoSuchBucket</Code>
  <Message>The specified bucket does not exist</Message>
  <BucketName>inlanefreight</BucketName>
  <RequestId>TR61BN170VZ3AXN3</RequestId>
  <HostId>8BZc3T/xP+Rzz1TGWYEaufnZuQKe2tqDoxGx7LsfgeyEXoyWWmz2onPByeI36iwD</HostId>
</Error>
```

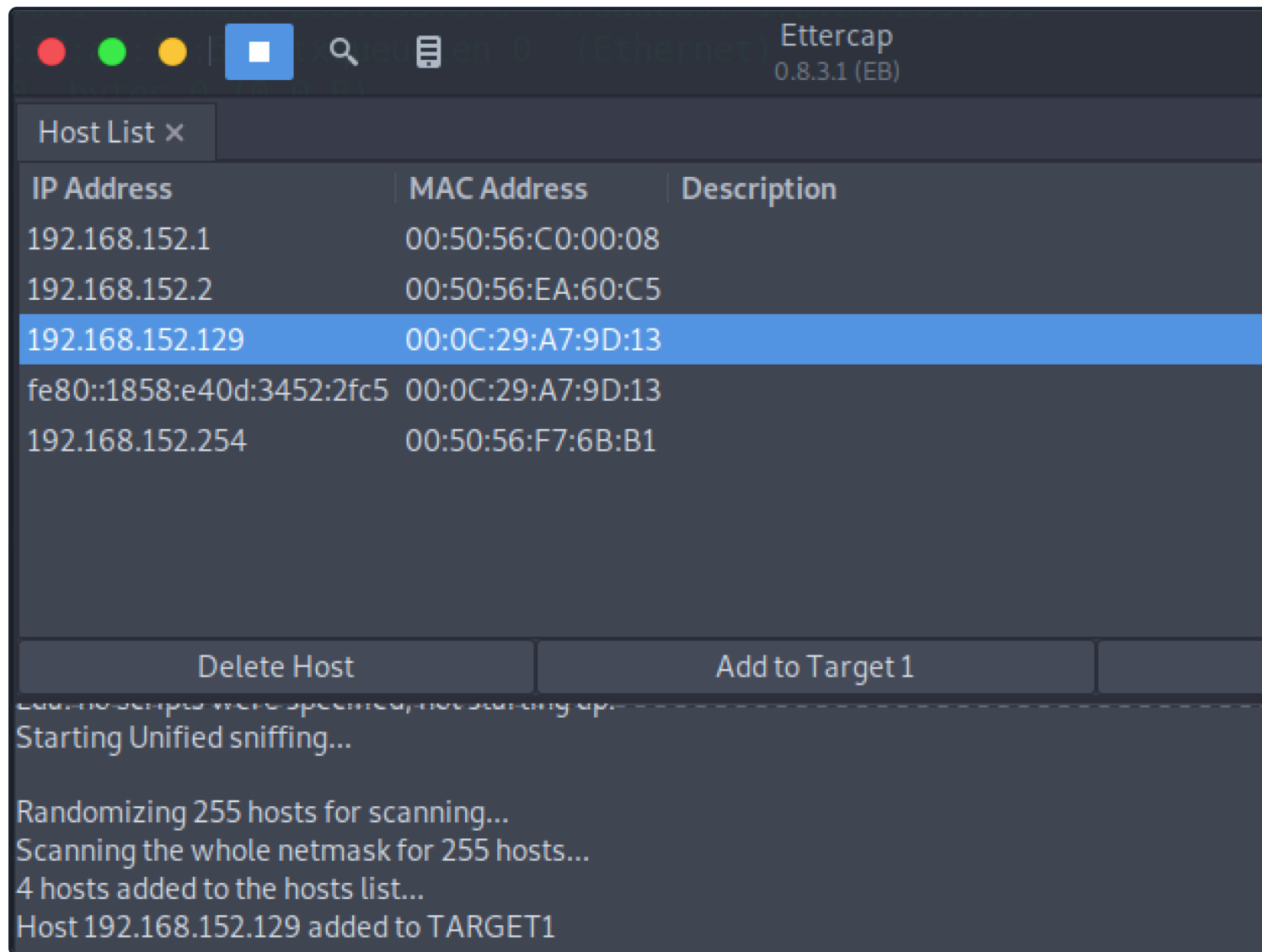
The [can-i-take-over-xyz](#) repository is also an excellent reference for a subdomain takeover vulnerability. It lists various services that are vulnerable to a subdomain takeover and provides guidelines on assessing the vulnerability.

DNS Spoofing

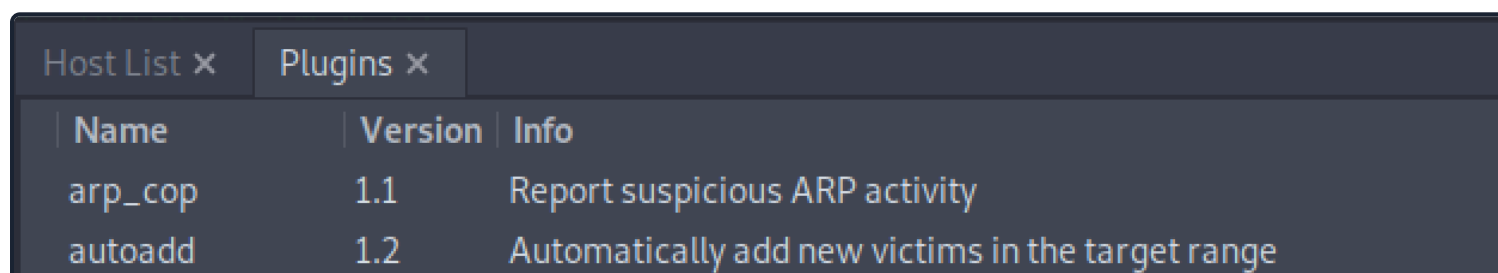
```
dbcyph0n@htb[/htb]# cat /etc/ettercap/etter.dns
```

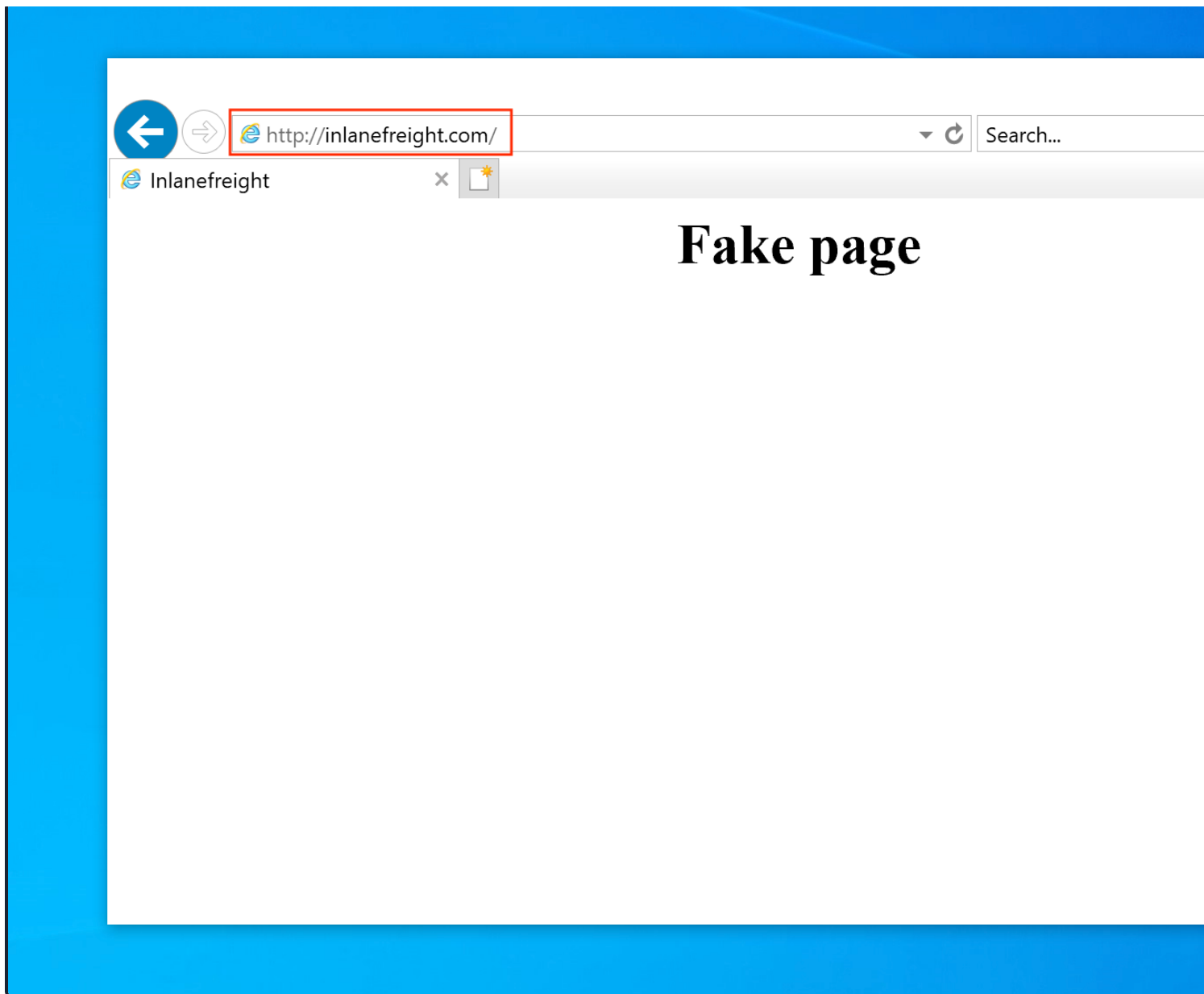
```
inlanefreight.com      A    192.168.225.110
*.inlanefreight.com    A    192.168.225.110
```

Next, start the **Ettercap** tool and scan for live hosts within the network by navigating to **Hosts > Scan for live hosts**. Add the target IP address (e.g., **192.168.152.129**) to Target1 and add a default gateway IP (e.g., **192.168.152.1**) to Target2.



Activate **dns_spoof** attack by navigating to **Plugins > Manage Plugins**. This sends the target machine to resolve **inlanefreight.com** to IP address **192.168.225.110**:





In addition, a ping coming from the target IP address **192.168.152.129** to **inlanefreight.com** should be well:

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```
C:\>ping inlanefreight.com
```

```
Pinging inlanefreight.com [192.168.225.110] with 32 bytes of data:
```

```
Reply from 192.168.225.110: bytes=32 time<1ms TTL=64
```

```
Reply from 192.168.225.110: bytes=32 time<1ms TTL=64
```

```
Reply from 192.168.225.110: bytes=32 time<1ms TTL=64
```

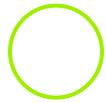
```
Reply from 192.168.225.110: bytes=32 time<1ms TTL=64
```

```
Ping statistics for 192.168.225.110:
```

```
    Packets: Sent = 4, Received = 4, Lost = 0 (0% loss),
```

```
Approximate round trip times in milli-seconds:
```

```
    Minimum = 0ms, Maximum = 0ms, Average = 0ms
```



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Pwnbox Location

AU

Terminate Pwnbox to switch location

Start Instance

∞ / 1 spawns left

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 Start Instance

 / 1 spawns left